



HR MANUAL

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INTRODUCTION

M/S TECHAHEAD SOFTWARE PVT. LTD. (hereinafter referred to as “TECHAHEAD”/ “Company”) welcomes you to the organization and we look forward to working with you. Our success is founded on the skill and effort of our employees. We strive to make the Company a good place to work and a place where you will be treated fairly and with dignity. The Company would like to help you get off to a good start.

The first thing you should do is read this HR Manual carefully.

This HR Manual is designed to answer many of your questions about the policies and procedures that apply to your employment with the Company, to serve as a reference for questions concerning the Company’s policies as they particularly affect you, and to provide general information about Leaves and other benefits the Company offers to you.

This HR Manual supersedes all previous personnel policies and procedures of TECHAHEAD (formal and informal). The policies and procedures contained in this HR Manual are binding upon the employees of TECHAHEAD and the same is acknowledged at the time of taking up the employment. The Company reserves the right to add/ edit/ delete contents of the Manual at any time to reflect the updates in policies and procedures that the Company follows.

The company attempts to provide written notice of any major change to employees or to post such a notice in a place accessible to employees before the effective date of the change. The latest amended version of the policy will govern the HR Policy.

This HR Manual is the property of the Company. You have been provided with a copy of the same for reading and referring to during your employment with the Company. On termination of your employment for any reason or upon request by the Company at any time, this HR Manual must be returned immediately. Please read all the policies and procedures in this HR Manual, as each employee will be required to sign an Acknowledgment to the effect that he or she has read and agrees to abide by the policies and procedures contained in the HR Manual.

Please do not hesitate to ask for help with any questions that may arise. Should you have any questions that are not answered in this HR Manual, your supervisor or another member of Company management will be glad to help.

Human Resource Department
TechAhead Software Pvt Ltd
Plot No-B8, 7A Floor, Tower-C,
Noida One, Sector-62,
Noida, Uttar Pradesh 201301

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THE COMPANY- OVERVIEW

Established in the year 2009, M/S TECHAHEAD SOFTWARE PRIVATE LIMITED is an Indian Private Limited Company which is a pioneer in the field of mobile application development and IT services and engaged in the designing and development of applications for Web, iPhones, iPads and Android-powered devices in India. The Company has a global clientele and provides high-quality IT solutions to its customers.

TECHAHEAD is committed to maintaining the highest level of professionalism, honesty, integrity, and fairness in its transactions with its clients and pledges to continue with the same.

1) GENERAL MANAGEMENT PRACTICE

1.1 Equal Employment Policy

That the term “Employee(s)” in this HR Manual shall mean and include permanent employees as well as the probationers until and unless expressly stated. This HR Manual shall not apply or include Contractual employees until and unless specifically stated herein.

It is the policy of TECHAHEAD to provide equal employment opportunities to all its employees and applicants for employment and not to discriminate on any basis prohibited by law, including race, color, sex, religion, national origin, disability, marital status, or any other status or condition protected by the applicable center, state, or local laws except where a bona fide occupational qualification applies. It is the intent and desire of the Company that equal employment opportunities be provided in employment, recruitment, selection, compensation, benefits, promotion, demotion, layoff, termination, and all other related employment procedures of the Company. The Manager HR, at TECHAHEAD and all its managerial personnel, are committed to this policy and its enforcement.

Employees are directed to bring any violation of this policy to the immediate attention of their reporting manager or the Head of HR, of TECHAHEAD. Any employee who violates this policy or knowingly retaliates against an employee reporting or complaining of a violation of this policy shall be subject to immediate disciplinary action, up to and including termination from services. Complaints brought under this policy will be promptly investigated and handled with due regard for the privacy and respect of all involved.

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1.2 Employment Classification:

For the sole purpose of determining the allowance of certain employee benefits, employees are classified as:

- i) CEO
- ii) CC&CSO
 - (1) VP, Sales & Marketing
 - (a) Sales Managers & Executive
 - (b) Marketing Managers & Executives
- iii) CTO
- iv) COO
 - (1) VP – Delivery
 - (a) Sr. Project Manager
 - (b) Project Manager
 - (c) Technical Delivery Manager
 - (d) Associate Technical Delivery Manager
 - (e) Business Analyst
 - (2) Architects/Manager Technology
 - (a) Tech Lead
 - (b) Associate Tech Lead
 - (i) Sr. Software Engineer
 - (ii) Software Engineer
 - (iii) Associate Software Engineer
 - (iv) Software Trainee
 - (3) QA Manager
 - (a) QA Lead
 - (i) Associate Lead QA
 - 1. Sr. Software Engineer - Testing
 - 2. Software Engineer Testing
 - 3. Associate Software Engineer Testing
 - 4. Trainee QA
 - (4) Head of Design
 - (a) Creative Head
 - (b) UI UX Designer

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- (c) UI Developer
- (d) Trainee
- (5) Assoc. Director HR
 - (a) Manager Human Resource
 - (b) Sr. Executive HR
 - (c) Executive HR
- (6) GM Operations
 - (a) Admin
 - (b) System Admin
- (7) Finance and Accounts

1.3 Harassment Prevention Policy

1.3.1 Policy related to General Harassment: -

Commitment

TECHAHEAD is committed to providing a work environment that ensures every employee is treated with dignity and respect and is afforded equitable treatment. TECHAHEAD will not tolerate harassment or intimidation of any employee on any basis prohibited by law, including race, color, sex, age, religion, national origin, sexual preferences, physical disability, marital status, veteran status, etc. within the office premises or outside at the time of carrying out of his/her duty on behalf the Company. Moreover, any suggestions made to any employee that any type of favors will affect any term or condition of employment with TECHAHEAD will not be tolerated. It is the policy of TECHAHEAD that any harassment, including acts creating a hostile work environment or any other discriminatory acts directed against its employees, will result in immediate disciplinary action, and may include termination from services. TECHAHEAD also will not tolerate any such harassment or intimidation of its employees by clients or vendors.

Scope:

This policy shall apply to all the employees of TECHAHEAD including any employee engaged in fixed-term short-term, permanent, temporary, apprentice, trainees, contract persons, and visitors on the Company's premises. It shall include the unwelcome behavior of sexual nature mentioned in the policy or sending vulgar and obscene image(s)/video(s)/video clipping(s)/message(s)/text(s) or passing remarks which are derogatory

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or hurts the religious sentiments of any staff and/or member of the Company by any of its employee's suppliers, contractor including the agents, supervisors, managers, etc.

Workplace:

The workplace includes: -

1. All offices or other premises where TECHAHEAD's business is conducted.
2. All Company-related activities performed at any other site away from the Company's premises.
3. Any social, business, or other functions where the conduct or comments may hurt the workplace or workplace relations.

1.3.2 Policy related to Sexual Harassment: -

Sexual harassment in the workplace is considered a violation of women's right to equality, life, and liberty. It creates an insecure and hostile work environment, which discourages women's participation in work, thereby adversely affecting their social and economic empowerment and the goal of inclusive growth.

TechAhead, in the light of "The Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013" has incorporated this harassment prevention policy to ensure that the women employees at TechAhead feel safe, secure, and progressive.

Please note that the POSH Policy is documented and updated separately. Employees are advised to go through the policy in detail to ensure awareness and compliance

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2) CODE OF CONDUCT

It is the policy of TECHAHEAD to provide a code of conduct for its employees which will serve as a guide to the proper business conduct of all the employees of the Company. TECHAHEAD expects all the employees to observe the highest code of conduct and integrity in their conduct. This means following a basic code of such ethical behavior that includes the followings: -

2.1 Build Trust and Credibility

The growth of TECHAHEAD and its employees is dependent on the trust and the confidence it earns from its employees, customers, clients, and shareholders. The Company gains credibility by adhering to its commitments, displaying honesty and integrity, and reaching Company's goal solely through honorable conduct.

2.2 Respect for the Individual

All the employees of TECHAHEAD are required to work in an environment where everyone is treated with dignity and respect which, in turn, contributes directly to the success of the Company. This policy provides the framework of principles for conducting business and dealing with customers, colleagues, and other stakeholders which are to:

- i) Act with integrity and professionalism and be scrupulous in the proper use of Company information, funds, equipment mentoring, and facilities.
- ii) Exercise fairness, equity, proper courtesy, consideration, and sensitivity in dealing with customers, employees, and other stakeholders; and
- iii) Avoid real or apparent conflict of interests.

2.3 Responsibilities

- i) Employees are required to promote the interests of the Company.
- ii) Perform their duties with skill, honesty, care, and diligence, using authority fairly and equitably.
- iii) Abide by policies and procedures, instructions, and lawful directions that relate to their employment and duties; and

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- iv) Comply with the spirit as well as the letter of the codes of conduct applying to the professions of individual Employees.
- v) Apprise Employer about any inappropriate or unethical or illegal activity taking place within the premises of TechAhead.

2.4 Gifts, Favor, and Conflict of Interest

- i) Employees must avoid any personal, financial, or other conflict of interest that may be directly associated in conflict with their duties and responsibilities to and for the Company.
- ii) Any interest which may constitute a conflict of interest of the Company must be promptly disclosed to an appropriate senior manager/team leader.
- iii) Accepting any external appointment, such as a board appointment, working for another organization, or conducting a business, is not permitted without prior intimation and written permission of the management of the Company.
- iv) Employees should never offer or accept gifts or favor from any other person (being a third party) in circumstances where the outcome of a transaction may be influenced by the gift/favor or give rise to the perception that the transaction may be influenced by the gift/favor.

Any employee found in violation of this clause shall be terminated from his services with immediate effect by the Company without any prior notice with/without pay, based on the profundity of the conduct of the defaulting party.

2.5 Business Communication

Network and Electronic Resources, such as computers, other hardware, software, e-mail, landline, and cellular telephones, fax machines, printers, scanners, photocopiers, internet access, etc. are tools that TECHAHEAD provides its employees to assist them in their work. These Network and Electronic Resources and related access systems are proprietary Company's property and are subject to review or access by TECHAHEAD at any time without any prior intimation to such users.

Inappropriate use of networks and Electronic Resources like using personal internet during office hours or using office internet connection for chatting on social media, self-promotion, access to job sites, networking/

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movies/ video/ porn video clip downloading, surfing of social or pornographic website shall result in immediate disciplinary actions, up to and including termination from services without notice.

Employees shall not download, copy, extract and forward the TECHAHEAD's confidential or proprietary information via e-mail, Bluetooth, pen drive/hard disk/USB flash drives, or any other removable storage medium to any third person outside the office premises of the Company or even to other employees of the Company unless such recipients are authorized to receive such information. Employees must not copy or send by e-mail any information, including software that is protected by copyright laws, and the employees should also be careful to safeguard their passwords, log off their terminals when not in use and not permit others to access Company's systems. They shall further be responsible for the safekeeping of the computer network, computer system, computer database, or any other programmes in such computer, provided to them by TECHAHEAD during their employment.

2.6 Non-Disclosure and non-Solicitation

As the result of their employment at TECHAHEAD, the employees will acquire and have access to both proprietaries as well as confidential information belonging to the Company of special and unique value. Confidential information shall mean and include but not limited to any and all technical data, materials, products, technology, computer programs, specifications, manuals, business plan software-hardware are configuration/designs, processes, formulae, research projects, invention description(s), technical and business information relating to proprietary ideas and inventions, ideas, trade secrets, drawings and/or illustrations, existing and/or contemplated products and services, research and development, production, cost, profit and margin information, finances and financial projections, customers, clients, marketing and current or future business plans and models and all other information in any form whatsoever that pertains to present or future business operations, processes and nature of work done by the Company or any of customer, irrespective of whether any Non-Disclosure Agreement is signed with the customer or not and regardless of whether such information is designated as "Confidential Information" at the time of its disclosure.

An Employee shall acknowledge, agree, and undertake the following terms: -

- i) That the Company is the absolute, unrestricted, and exclusive owner of all the Confidential Information as described in the foregoing paragraph.
- ii) That an Employee during his tenure of service in the Company or 5 (five) years thereafter, shall not, except for a legitimate business purpose of the Company or unless so required by law, use or sale or publish or otherwise disclose, distribute, or divulge to others, any or all such confidential information

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of the Company, in any manner, whatsoever, without the written authorization from the Management of the Company.

- iii) That an Employee during his employment or five years from the date of his/her termination of services with the Company, use or attempt to use any such Confidential and/or Proprietary Information in any manner which may injure or cause loss either directly or indirectly to the Company, its business, or its existing/previous/prospective customers to who the Company has submitted proposals.
- iv) That an Employee in possession of any/all Confidential Information of the Company shall use it with the same degree of care and protection that it takes to protect one's Confidential Information
- v) That the Company has received and shall receive in future Confidential Information from third parties, subject to a duty on the Company's part to maintain the confidentiality of such information and to use it only for a limited purpose. An Employee agrees that owes the Company and such third parties, during the term of his employment and from then on, a duty to hold all such confidential information in the strictest of confidence and not to disclose it to any other person, company, or corporation (except as necessary in carrying out any work for the Company consistent with the Company's agreement with such third party) or to use it for the benefit of anyone other than for the Company or such third party (consistent with the Company's agreement with such third party) without the express written authorization of the Company.
- vi) That while discharging duties/obligations towards the Company if an employee is in doubt as to whether specific information is to be Confidential or not, the Employee shall immediately request written clarification from his immediate supervisor.
- vii) That at the time of resignation/termination of his services of the Company, such Employee shall immediately return all Confidential Information received in written or tangible form, including copies or reproductions or other media containing such Confidential Information, and deliver up to the Company all intangible information relating to the business and operations of the Company that may be in his possession on account of the nature of his duty i.e. passwords, customer lists, project files, etc. to the satisfaction of the Company and shall give an undertaking that the said information has not been unauthorizedly retained by the Employee in any form. The Employee shall not attempt to retain or recreate unauthorized copies, notes, extracts, or reproductions of any Confidential Information, record, or other information of the Company. Any failure on this account shall amount to misappropriation of the Company's property and the Company shall have the right to take appropriate legal proceedings both civil and criminal against the defaulter as may be available to the Company under the applicable laws of the country.

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- viii) The Employees during their employment with the Company or at the time of resignation/termination of his/her services and thereafter shall not steal, conceal, destroy, alter, or cause any person to steal, conceal, destroy, alter any computer source code used for a computer resource to cause damage or disruption of the Company's business.

That an Employee during the term of his employment and for 3(Three) years immediately following the termination of his employment with the Company, for any reason whatsoever shall not: -

- i) Hire any employees of the Company, and will not either directly or indirectly, solicit, induce, attempt to influence, or encourage any of the Company's employees to leave their employment with the Company or to enter into any employment or other business relationship with any other person (including the erstwhile employee), Company or corporation or take away such employees, or make an attempt either for himself or for any other person or entity.

Interfere, solicit either directly or indirectly contact with any of the Company's existing customers previous customers, or prospective customers to whom the Company has submitted a proposal, for the any of the following purposes: a) selling or otherwise providing of similar products or services the Company is in the business of selling or otherwise providing; b) encouraging the former, existing or prospectus customer to cease doing their business with the Company or to curtail its business with the Company or not to commence its business with the Company. Without the prior written consent of the Company: -

- i) serve as a partner, employee, consultant, officer, director, manager, agent, associate, investor, or otherwise or,
ii) directly or indirectly, own, purchase, organize or take preparatory steps for the organization of, or
iii) build, design, finance, acquire, lease, operate, manage, work or consult for or otherwise affiliate himself, in any business which is in direct competition with or similar to the Company's business in any territory whatsoever.

2.7 Public Statements

The Company's relationships with the media (traditional and social) and the investment community are conducted exclusively by the management of the Company or as delegated by the board.

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The Employee understands that it is difficult to establish the veracity of posts or comments by him/ her made on the public platform, any social media blogs, or Company review platforms including but not limited to LinkedIn, Glassdoor, etc. Therefore, in view to protect the genuine interest of the Company in the global market, the Employee during the tenure of his/ her services at TECHAHEAD and for 02 (two) years thereafter shall not make any posts, comments, or reviews in any form at the public platform, any social media blogs, Company review platforms including but not limited to LinkedIn, Glassdoor, Twitter, Facebook, etc. which degrade, defame, malign or cast aspersions on the image of TECHAHEAD.

Non-Disparagement Clause: -

The Employee agrees that during the subsistence of this agreement or for three (3) years after expiration the hereof he/she shall not through any writing/posting/or any content format on any internet labeling blogs, social media such as Facebook, LinkedIn or Twitter or any other platform, disparage, defame, malign or cast aspersions on the business format, integrity competence or professionalism of the company or its stakeholders unless admitted in writing by the Company or proved in a court of law and upon violation of any such term the delinquent shall remain bound and committed to paying a sum of Rs 2.5 lac carrying interest @ 24% p.a. from the date of such publication till the date of receipt of such money by TechAhead or till the issuance of valid discharge by the Company, as liquidated damages for each instance of any violation as above stated.

2.8 Compliance

1. Employees must be aware of and adhere to the Company policies, especially those relating to health and safety, equal opportunity, privacy, trade practices, and continuous disclosure.
2. In the course of their duties, Employees must comply with relevant applicable laws, rules, and regulations both for the individuals and business of the Company.

2.9 Use of Position for Personal Benefit

No employee shall use his/ her position with the Company for the personal benefit or gain other than the compensation paid to him/ her by the Company, or for the profit or gain (other than the compensation paid to him/her by the Company), or for the profit or gain of any family member.

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2.10 Breaches of the Code

1. Employees must observe the code and ensure that no breach occurs. Breaches require immediate attention, and Employees must report known or suspected breaches of the code.
2. Any employee who in good faith makes a complaint or disclosure about an alleged breach of the code, and follows the reporting procedure outlined below, will not be disadvantaged, or prejudiced in the making of such a complaint or disclosure. All reports will be treated as confidential.
3. A complaint or disclosure about an alleged breach of the code should be in writing and contain details about the date, time, and nature of the alleged breach and include any available supporting material.
4. Complaint, if any, should be made to the Employee's immediate supervisor/team leader.
5. The person to whom the complaint is made should undertake a prompt and thorough investigation and determine whether any action is required.
6. The Employee will be informed of the outcome of the investigation.
7. Employees may at any time discuss a matter or seek advice on how to proceed with a matter, from the Head- of HR & Legal, or any other senior executive.

2.11 Smoking, Drinking, using Recreational Drugs or other intoxicants in the Workplace

TECHAHEAD's policy is to provide a conducive environment for its employees, customers, vendors, and the general public. Using intoxicants of any kind is prohibited inside the office premises and on the worksites.

Employees must bring to the knowledge of administration on joining of duties if they use any intoxicants. Furthermore, using them is strictly prohibited during office hours. Any Employee found consuming alcohol, recreational drugs, or any other intoxicant inside the office premises of the Company during working hours, / shall be terminated from his/her services immediately.

3) HOURS OF WORK AND PAYROLL

3.1 Working Hours

The regularly scheduled workday for the Company is Monday to Friday from 10:00 A.M till 7:00 P.M including lunchtime up to 40 minutes and 20 minutes of short breaks. Employees can choose his/her lunchtime between 1:00 P.M.-3:00 P.M.

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Official Saturday

Official Saturdays are those Saturdays' when employees are called for training, official events, urgent meetings, etc. The Company remains closed on Saturdays, however, due to unforeseen project issues, slippages, or training, the employees might be required to come on the Official Saturdays. Any absence of the permanent Employee on the official Saturday would lead to deduction of his/ her Casual Leave. However, the absence of a probationer on the official Saturday would lead to the deduction of the one day's salary of the defaulting probationer.

Leave from the office for up to four (4) hours will be considered a half-day leave, however, leave from the office for more than 4 (four) hours will be a full day's leave.

In case of unplanned conditions, such as bad weather, that may force a schedule change at the last minute, the Employee(s) should contact his/her immediate senior or call the COO & Manager HR directly.

Official Sunday

Sunday is a full holiday and any permanent employee(s) coming to the office on a Sunday and working for at least 6 hours shall be entitled to an additional full day leave which would be added to their respective Compensatory Off which can be availed after the approval of the Manager HR or PM of the Company.

3.2 Pay Period and Pay Day

TECHAHEAD credits the salary account of every Employee and provides stipends to every trainee on the 7th day of every English calendar month. The pay periods start on the 1st of every month and end on the last day of the month. Thereafter, on every 7th day of the month, Employees will receive a salary and stipend (in the case of a trainee) for all the days they have worked in the pay period ending the last day of the previous month.

4) EMPLOYEE BENEFIT PROGRAMS

4.1 Leaves & Holidays

Objective:

To ensure work-life balance amongst employees, to take care of any personal emergencies/exigencies that may arise in the normal course, and to provide them with an opportunity to rejuvenate by way of planned leaves.

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Scope:

The policy applies to all employees at the company. The policy does not apply to staff members who are on a Third-Party Contract as they are governed by the contract entered with the third-party vendor.

Policy Details: Leave calendar year for all the leaves is 1 January to 31 December.

Types of Leave:

- Earned Leave
- Casual Leave
- Sick Leave
- Maternity Leave
- Paternity Leave
- Bereavement Leave
- Unpaid Leave
- Short Leaves

4.1.1 Earned Leaves:

The employee can avail themselves of Earned Leaves to meet any medical/personal emergencies. Earned leave can be availed for even half a day. Employees can take Earned leaves up to the maximum of their accumulated Earned Leave balance, subject to approval from their reporting manager.

Earned Leave (EL) - 12 Leaves available after 1 Year of service with the organization

Maximum Earned Leaves that can be carried forward to next year is 8.

- The leave must be approved by the reporting manager before the employee proceeds on leave.
- All short term Earned Leaves (i.e., ≤ 3 days leaves), needs to be applied at least 7 days in advance of leave start date
- All long-term Earned Leaves (i.e., > 3 days leaves), need to be applied at least 4 weeks in advance from the leave start date.

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- Maximum of 5 days earned Leaves can be availed in one quarter, if it extends beyond it shall be treated as leave without pay.
- In case earned leave(s) are not applied as per the rules mentioned above, leave application would go to Second Level Manager or HR and it will be at the discretion of the Second Level Manager or HR to approve it or mark it leave without pay.

At any given time, you are limited to applying for those many leaves that got accrued as of the date for which you are applying for leave.

4.1.2 Casual Leave (CL):

The employee can avail of Casual Leave to meet any personal emergencies. Casual leave can be availed for even half a day. Employees can take Casual leaves up to the maximum of their balance, subject to approval from their reporting manager.

Casual Leave (CL) - 6 CL (can be availed for any personal exigency)

- The Leaves can be availed for only two consecutive days.
- All Casual Leaves need to apply at least 4 days in advance to leave start date.
- In case, Casual leave(s) are not applied as per the rules mentioned above, leave application would go to Second Level Manager for approval

4.1.3 Sick Leave (SL):

The employee can avail of Sick Leave to meet any medical emergencies. Sick leave can be availed for even half a day. Employees can take Sick leaves up to the maximum of their balance, subject to approval from their reporting manager.

Sick Leave (SL) - 6 SL (can be availed if employees are sick or not feeling well)

- In case, Sick leave(s) are not applied as per the rules mentioned above, leave application would go to Second Level Manager for approval
- In a row the employee can avail of a maximum of 2 days of sick leaves. However, if the sick leaves extend beyond 2 days, then the excess days of leave taken will be treated as leave without pay. However, the Project manager and the HR department have the discretionary power to sanction the leave beyond two days in a row depending on a case-to-case basis

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- The employee taking sick leave beyond two days is required to produce the medical certificate from a qualified and registered medical practitioner immediately after re-joining the services with TECHAHEAD. In case an adequate number of sick leave is not available with the permanent Employee, he/ she can club the earned leave however if the earned leave is not left, then leave so taken shall be termed as leave without pay clubbing of the leaves shall not be taken as a matter of right, prior approval of Reporting Manager/ HR department is required.
- **Holidays and weekly offs falling between the period of the leave will be counted as leave.**

Note:

Leave Accounting Year

All the leave account is operated on a calendar year basis i.e., from 1st January to 31st December.

- **EL, CL & SL (will credit every year)**

4.1.4 Maternity Leave:

All women employees, who have worked continuously at TECHAHEAD for 80 days in twelve months immediately preceding her expected delivery, shall be eligible for paid maternity leave to cover a period of confinement, pregnancy, miscarriage, abortion, adoption. In the case where an employee has worked for less than the period, such a member shall not be entitled to any Maternity Benefit under the Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act, 2017, and any leave taken will either be considered Casual Leave or LWP as a break in services without assurance of continuation.

- i) Maternity leave will apply to all female team members for confinement and recuperation. Women employees to avail of the maternity leave must produce the medical certificate issued by the medical practitioner indicating the expected date their her confinement.
- ii) The team member may notify the leave sanction authority member in writing at least 1 month before the delivery date. In case any Female team member fails to notify the above-said member when she was pregnant may give such notice immediately after the delivery. Maternity Benefit shall be paid to such an employee only after the receipt of the said notice by the Leave Sanction Authority.

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- iii) Female team members shall be entitled to the maternity benefit for a maximum period of 26 weeks, 8 weeks up to and including the day of her delivery. This period of leave is only applicable to the first two children of the family.
- iv) In the case of a female team member who is already having two or more surviving children, the maternity benefit available to her shall be 12 weeks of which not more than 6 weeks shall precede the date of her expected delivery.
- v) In case a female team member adopts a child below the age of three months, or a commissioning mother shall be entitled to maternity leave for 12 weeks from the date the child is handed over to a female team member commissioning mother means a biological mother who uses her egg to create an embryo implanted in any other woman.
- vi) In case a female team member suffers a fatality during the aforesaid period, the maternity benefit shall be payable only for the days including up to and including the day of her demise.
- vii) In case of miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy, the team member will be entitled to maternity benefit for the entire period. Such entitlement is subject to the production of a medical certificate to that effect.
- viii) The female member shall not be employed for 6 weeks immediately following the day of her delivery or her miscarriage.
- ix) In case of miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy, a female team member shall be entitled to leave with wages for six weeks immediately following the date of her miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy on the production of satisfactory medical proof therefor.
- x) In case a female team member is suffering from any illness arising out of pregnancy, delivery, premature birth of the child, miscarriage, medical termination of pregnancy, or tubectomy operation, she shall be entitled to leave with wages of the month in addition to the leaves already allowed to her under maternity benefit. The female team member shall intimate at least one week before the last date of completion of her maternity benefit of 26 weeks along with valid medical proof thereof in case she desires to avail of such a one-month extension.
- xi) If the nature of work allowed to a female team member is of such nature that she may work from home for a maximum of one month after completion of her maternity leaves, she may be allowed to work from home on such terms and conditions as TechAhead and the female team member may mutually agree.
- xii) No female team member shall be put to any work which is arduous or which involves long hours of standing or which in any way is likely to interfere in her pregnancy or normal development of

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the fetus or is otherwise to adversely affect her health for 01 months immediately preceding six weeks before the date of her expected delivery.

- xiii) In case a female team member chooses to work at her workplace after she has been allowed to absent herself on the pretext of maternity benefits, her maternity benefit shall be deemed to have forfeited by such a female team member.
- xiv) A female team member shall immediately resume her work after completion of her maternity leaves period or extension (if granted for illness arising out of pregnancy). In case a female team member does not resume her duties at work after completion of her maternity benefits or extension, then such female team member shall be deemed to be on unauthorized leave and appropriate action shall be taken against her.

Please Note Any weekly off or Company Holiday that falls during Maternity leave will be considered as part of leave.

4.1.5 Paternity Leave:

- A male employee is eligible for 3 working days of paid paternity leave for the birth of his child. A formal communication along with documentary evidence is to be submitted to the HR/Reporting manager.
- His leave must be availed within 30 days of the child's birth and in continuation.
- Paternity leave can be either pre-fixed or suffixed with weekly offs/ Leave without Pay/ Company Holidays/ Restricted Holidays.
- Paternity leaves must be applied in continuation.

4.1.6 Bereavement Leaves:

In the event of death of the blood relative of any permanent Employee, such Employee is entitled to take leaves for a maximum period of 3 days.

4.1.7 Unpaid Leave:

It is not the policy of the company to encourage this practice. Under exceptional circumstances like serious illness, the employee can avail of such leave after seeking approval from the approving authority. This may be sanctioned only when all other forms of leave are exhausted. Weekends/ Holidays in between will be counted as a part of Leave without Pay. Eg: If an employee goes for Leave without Pay from 21st January (Wednesday) to 30th January (Friday), he/she will not receive pay for 26th January. The number of leave days considered in this case would be 10 days.

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The limit of LWP will be 30 calendar days (Max) aggregated in a year including weekends and holidays falling in between the leave duration.

All LWP needs to be approved by the Second level manager and HR.

Unauthorized Absence:

Any absence from duty must be authorized. If an employee is absent from the duty without authorization, such absence will be treated as an unauthorized absence. In such cases, the employee is not entitled to salary for that period and will not be able to apply for any other type of leave except for unauthorized absence which is permitted by RM and HR. Further, the HR and RM can apply for this leave on behalf of employees absent from duty and only the HR and RM can cancel this leave.

Note:

1. Any leave taken by an employee without the consent /approval of Management will fall under the purview of Unscheduled leave/Unauthorized Leave and will incur necessarily disciplinary action.
2. All rejected LWP's will be treated as Unauthorized Absence and A (Absent) will be marked for those number of days.
3. Any unplanned leave/leaves clubbing with a long weekend will be treated as LWP (leave without pay)
4. Any unplanned Friday & Monday clubbing during the weekend will be treated as LWP (leave without pay)
5. In case an employee has not reported working on a particular day and filled his/her Time Sheet (Keka/Zoho/Any other tool) for that day then HR can mark him/her as absent for that day and disciplinary action will be taken

4.1.8 Short Leaves:

All the employees are entitled to have only one short leave in a month. The employee can reach the office by 12:00 P.M. or may leave early after 5:00 P.M on any of the one working day in a month beyond which one-fourth of the day's salary will be deducted for each such delay.

4.1.9 Intervening Holidays:

Intervening holidays/weekends will be considered for leave calculation only for Earned Leave. E.g.: If an employee has applied for Earned Leaves from (Friday) to (Wednesday), then the number of leaves calculated is 4 days.

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To apply for intervening Holidays employee, need to take prior approval from the respective manager if the employee extends his leave of intervening Holiday without prior approval. It will be treated as LWP and the complete leave period will be counted as LWP including week-off. E.g.: If an employee has applied for one Earned Leave on (Friday) and does not turn up on (Monday), then the number of leaves calculated will be 4 days.

4.1.10 Holidays:

Company Holidays (CH)

- For company holidays please refer to the Holiday list on HRMS Portal.
- Company Holidays including the National holidays like Jan 26, Aug 15, and Oct 2 will remain mandatory holidays irrespective of the days that they fall under the holiday list.
- No additional holiday(s) will be given instead of the mandatory holiday falling on weekends.

Disclaimer – The Company reserves the right to alter, append or withdraw this policy either in part or in full based on management's discretion.

4.1.11 Procedure for Availing Leave

- All Employees desirous of availing any of the aforesaid leaves (as applicable on the respective Employees) must intimate to their respective Project Manager/ Reporting Manager. Employees have to apply for leave from HRMS "Apply Leave" or "Email" indicating the reasons and the duration of the leave.
- Leave for Project Manager/ Reporting Manager will be approved by their respective reporting manager and further notified to the HR department of the Company.
- All the leaves application of Employees must be approved in advance by the Project Manager/ Reporting Manager while those of the Project Manager/ Reporting Manager by their respective reporting managers, as described in the foregoing paragraphs, and any unauthorized and unsanctioned leave will be treated as "Absence from duty" or "Leave Without Pay".
- In case an employee is ill or is unable to attend office due to an emergency he/she shall immediately notify the said condition to his/her Project Manager/Reporting Manager/HR department, as the case may be on the same day over the phone and such Employee must submit his/her leave application without fail on the date of resuming his/her services failing which his/her leave shall be deemed as unauthorized and unsanctioned.

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- The Project Manager/ Reporting Manager is authorized to either grant or disapprove the leave on valid grounds, operational requirements, merits, reasonableness, and exigency of the Company's work. All the approved leave applications thereafter shall be submitted to the HR department for recordings and subsequent processing by the Employee.
- In case the leave sanction authority does not approve the leave of the employee, then the number of leaves taken by the employee would be automatically counted as leave(s) without pay. The deduction of the salary for the leave(s) without pay would be done on monthly basis.
- Any Employee absenting himself/herself from his/her duty for more than 7 days continuously without intimating to his/her Project Manager/Reporting Manager/HR department of the Company shall be deemed to have abandoned his/her services and the Company shall have the liberty to take immediate action against such Employee(s) as may be available with the Company under law. During the period of leave without pay, Employees are not entitled to any allowance/ pay whatsoever.

4.1.12 Cancellation of Leave

The Company reserves the exclusive right to and authority to cancel the leave of an Employee on an urgent need basis after intimating about the same to such Employee. However, if the Employee proceeds to avail the leaves so canceled, then such leaves taken by the Employee shall be treated as "absence from duty".

4.1.13 Extension of Leave

For an application for leave, an employee must get approval for the extension of leave by applying for a leave extension from his/ her reporting management/ HR department well in advance and get it sanctioned to avail of the extension.

4.2 Work from Home

Objective:

This model allows team members to have the flexibility to continue working in exceptional circumstances which doesn't permit the employee to operate and work from the office. The work-from-home model is open to all full-time team members.

4.2.1 When Are Team members Allowed to Work from Home: -

- WFH is by exception and not by rule!
- Team members, for exceptional reasons can work from home if permitted by the PM and the HR Manager.

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- It is mandatory to fill Zoho sheets & Keka while working from home & all the security tools must be installed to monitor productivity.
- Team members must be available by Email/Teams/Phone/Text during their working hours. They must respond within 30 mins; no response will be considered as the person is not present for the work and will be treated as unpaid leave.
- In case of any project or team's specific requirement, a team member must report to the office the same day.
- Employees will not carry out work for anyone other than TechAhead nor undertake any non-work-related activities during their work hours, without the prior permission of TechAhead.
- Employees shall ensure that they have proper IT system and technology to perform their job/duties from home.
- Employees will be dealing with the Proprietary and/or Confidential Information of TechAhead, therefore, the Employees shall strictly comply with the terms of the NDA.
- Reporting manager can approve the Work From Home requests for reasons that include but are not limited to – Parenting, Bad Weather, Family Emergencies, or any Medical Reasons.

Guidelines

1) WFH Allocation and Eligibility

For team members not assigned a permanent WFH status, the following limits apply:

- Quarterly Limit: A maximum of 5 WFH days may be availed per quarter.
- No Carry Forward: Unused WFH days will not carry over to the subsequent quarter.
- Reason-Based Approval: WFH is a facility provided for specific needs. Every request must be supported by a valid reason. Managers are instructed to review the necessity of each request before granting approval.

2) Keka Attendance and Clocking Procedures

To maintain the integrity of our attendance system, the following process is mandatory:

- Advance Approval: WFH must be applied for and approved in Keka prior to the commencement of the remote workday.
- Mandatory Clock In/Out: Once a WFH request is approved, team members must use the Clock In and Clock Out features in Keka.

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- Activity Tracking: You are required to Clock Out and Clock In every time you step away from your workstation during business hours to ensure accurate time logs.

3) WFH vs. Official Duty (OD)

- WFH: While working from home, you only need to Clock In/Out. There is no requirement to mark yourself as "On Duty" (OD).
- Official Duty (OD): The OD status is reserved strictly for instances where you are away on official company business (e.g., attending conferences like AWS re:Invent). In these cases, you are not "working from home" but are performing duties at an external location.

4) Exceptions and Extended Absence

- Policy Exceptions: Any request exceeding the 5-day quarterly limit requires a specific approval hierarchy: Reporting Manager > L2 Manager > L3 Manager. These exceptions must be intimated and approved in advance.
- Extended Absence: If you require more days away from the office than the WFH policy allows, you must avail your Privilege/Earned Leaves.
- Leave Prerequisite: Leaves will only be approved upon the satisfactory completion of all assigned tasks and deliverables due before the leave period.

Non-compliance and Consequence: -

Noncompliance with this Model like damage or misuse of office equipment for personal work or negligent damage or attending to personal work during office hours without the explicit permission of Reporting Manager or HR and any such acts that construe to be a violation of this Model will be viewed seriously by HR and appropriate action is taken including rules from other such policies.

4.3 Performance Review and Appraisal

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4.3.1 Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) Policy

Purpose

The Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) is a structured process designed to support employees whose performance does not meet the organization's defined expectations. The objective of a PIP is to clearly outline performance gaps, set measurable improvement goals, and provide a defined timeframe for improvement.

Applicability

This policy applies to all employees who are formally placed on a PIP following performance evaluations, feedback cycles, or management review, in accordance with company procedures.

PIP Duration

- The initial duration of a PIP will be four (4) weeks.
- Based on performance review outcomes, the PIP may be extended at the discretion of management and HR if improvement is observed but not yet sustained.
- The decision to close, extend, or take further action post-PIP rests solely with the organization.

Compensation Adjustment During PIP

- Employees placed on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) will receive a 15% reduced salary for the entire duration of the PIP period.
- This reduction is not a deferred, recoverable, or on-hold amount.
- The reduced portion of the salary will not be paid at any point, including after successful completion or closure of the PIP.
- Upon closure of the PIP, the employee's salary will be restored to the original structure prospectively, effective from the date of PIP closure only.
- No arrears, back pay, or retrospective compensation will be applicable for the PIP period under any circumstances.

Performance Review and Support

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- Clear performance expectations, goals, and timelines will be communicated in writing at the start of the PIP.
- Regular review meetings and feedback sessions will be conducted during the PIP period.
- While reasonable guidance and support may be provided, responsibility for performance improvement rests with the employee.

4.3.2 Performance Appraisal

Performance of permanent employees shall be reviewed by the management of the Company once a year, depending upon the employee's performance throughout the year. The appraisal process is structured into the following steps:

i. Employee Self-Assessment

Employees are required to complete the Performance & Development Review form, providing a self-assessment of their achievements, challenges, and goals.

ii. Manager Evaluation (L1 Manager)

The immediate Manager (L1) will review the self-assessment, evaluate the performance against assigned goals and KRAs, and provide ratings along with feedback.

iii. Manager of Manager Review (L2 Manager)

The Reviewer (L2 Manager/Delivery Head) will validate the appraisal inputs provided by the L1 Manager and ensure consistency and fairness in the evaluation.

iv. One-on-One Meetings

The L1 Manager will conduct a one-on-one discussion with the employee to share feedback, clarify ratings, and set development goals for the forthcoming year.

Based on the consolidated inputs from the above steps, the HR department will validate the appraisal forms, and the Appraisal Letter will be released accordingly.

Increment Guidelines:

- For employees completing their first year of service, the increment will be applicable upon completion of one year from their Date of Joining (DOJ).
- Post the first increment cycle, all employees will fall under the April and October appraisal cycles, depending on their assigned cycle.
- Increment in salary will be calculated on a pro-rata basis

Commitment Clause

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Employees are informed that their next appraisal will be aligned with the appraisal cycle assigned to them and will be due in the following year. By accepting the appraisal/increment letter, the employee agrees to remain committed to the organization for a minimum period of six (6) months from the date of issuance of the letter. In case an employee tenders their resignation before completing six (6) months from the issuance date, the organization reserves the right to recover 100% of the incremented portion of the salary granted through the appraisal

4.4 Referral Incentive Policy

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to motivate employees to refer skilled and good candidates to join TechAhead from time to time on a need basis.

Scope

This policy applies to all employees at TechAhead Software Pvt. Ltd. Except HR & Management

Eligibility

All the permanent Employees of TECHAHEAD including the new joiners are entitled to the Referral Incentive except those in the HR department and the Management of the Company.

- 1) For referring up to 3 years of experience, a team member can avail of the incentive amount once the referred member has completed 3 months of employment at TechAhead.
- 2) For referring between 3 to 5 years of experience, a team member can avail 50 % of the incentive amount after completion of 3 months and the rest 50 % of the incentive amount after the next 3 months i.e total of 6 months of completion of employment at TechAhead by a referred member.
- 3) For referring above 5 years of experience, a team member can avail incentive amount after completion of every 3 months' total amount will be paid in 9 months of completion of employment at TechAhead by a referred member.

Incentive amounts are as follows: -

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Referral Incentive Amount		
	Years of Experience	Amount (in Rs)
1	6 months to 1	5,000
2	1 to 3	10,000
3	3 to 5	20,000
4	5 to 8	30,000
5	8 to 10	40,000
6	10 and above	50,000

4.5 **Meal Reimbursement policy**

1. The team members of TECHAHEAD who are working from office-on-office holidays or working beyond 9 P.M. would be entitled to food reimbursement, which will be reimbursed fortnightly. The limit of reimbursement is Rs. 150 per person per meal.
2. That the form for availing this benefit is available with the guard at the reception.
3. The procedure to avail of the benefit is to fill the form and attach the food bill in respect of the meal consumed on that day then the employee is required to get the same approved by the Project Manager and submit the same to the Account Department.
4. The menu cards of the nearby restaurants are provided by the support staff in the cafeteria who can also arrange for the meals if informed before 8:00 P.M.
5. For carrying out the work smoothly the employee can share his/ her plans for coming to the office and working over the weekends with the operation team of TECHAHEAD.

4.6 **Project Closure Hangout Dinner**

After every completion of the project held by a particular team of TECHAHEAD, the delivery head of such team will announce the team – members’ names vide e-mail circulated by HR who would be entitled to “Project Closure

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Hangout policy. This policy should be availed in the same month when the project has been completed. It cannot be carried forward in any other month.

The forms for reimbursement of Rs. 500 per person shall be available with the Administrative Department of TECHAHEAD and after filling the same should be submitted to the accounts department after getting it approved from the Delivery head.

4.7 Rewards & Recognition

OBJECTIVE AND SCOPE OF THE POLICY

A rewards and recognition policy is designed to encourage employees to make a performance difference either individually or through teams. This rewards policy is to appreciate the good work of the Employees who outperform in their role and set an example for others with their skills, and accomplishments. The scope of this policy is to:

Provide a platform for employees to create an impact by delivering the best.

Provide Opportunities to get recognized in the area of work at a common platform in the organization.

APPLICABILITY: The policy applies to all employees of TechAhead Software Ltd.

KEY POLICY CLAUSE: The policy recognizes achievements or accomplishments that contribute to the overall objectives of the organization. The policy may provide both monetary and non-monetary awards.

TYPES OF AWARDS

- 1) Certificates
- 2) Gift Vouchers
- 3) Meals Vouchers
- 4) Plaques, trophies & certificates
- 5) Items such as caps, shirts & sweatshirts

TTYPE OF EMPLOYEE RECOGNITION

To ensure both fair and consistent application of recognition, a core set of rewards and recognition programs have been developed, as described below. Additional recognition programs may be added as deemed appropriate.

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IMMEDIATE EMPLOYEE RECOGNITION

This approach provides employee rewards and recognition at any time for the demonstration of behaviors and values of the organization, contributions to the goals and objectives of the organization or work unit, and acknowledgment of individual or team accomplishments.

Examples include rewards and recognition for:

- Any Client Appreciation Email
- Any PM/RM/HR Appreciation Mail

PLANNED EMPLOYEE RECOGNITION

This approach is characterized by pre-arranged, more frequently scheduled ways of acknowledging the contributions and accomplishments of an individual or team. This approach is less formal and provides more frequent opportunities to recognize employees.

Examples include rewards and recognition for:

- i. Teamwork award
- ii. Successful Project Completion Award
- ii. Exemplary Effort Award
- iii. Leadership Award
- iv. Outstanding Achievements award

LEVELS OF EMPLOYEE REWARDS & RECOGNITION

LEVEL ONE

To recognize a superb job on a project, task or activity or suggestions leading to the improvement of a work process, workflow -Up to 500 cash/non-cash

LEVEL TWO

To recognizes sustained outstanding achievement or contribution above and beyond standard job requirements or suggestions leading to improvements in the work process, workflow - Up to 3000 cash/non-cash

LEVEL THREE

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To recognize an extraordinary achievement or extraordinary contribution requiring a maximum effort that significantly impacted customer service and productivity that is not likely to repeat itself – Surprise Gifts

MANAGEMENT RESPONSIBILITY

1. Each Delivery Head shall determine how the policy is to be administered within their respective areas within the pre-allotted budget.
2. A written plan will be developed that indicates the type of reward and recognition programs to be used, the nomination process, the criteria for determining the level of the award, the approval process, and the communication plan.
3. The written plan will be reviewed by Manager HR for adherence to the organization's policy for recognition and approval at the level of COO before implementation.
4. Based on the individual contributions of employees who have demonstrated a high level of job performance, quality customer service with adherence to TechAhead mission and values will be declared the winner.
5. Selected employees will receive a Recognition Award Certificate and other gift prizes.
6. HR will organize **"TechAhead Commendation Day"** in the subsequent month.
7. The winners will be appreciated and rewarded in presence of all Team members.

Disclaimer: The contents of this handbook are presented as a matter of information. The company reserves its rights to modify, change, disregard, suspend or cancel at any time, without written or verbal notice, all or any part of the handbook's contents as circumstances may require.

5) Payment of Gratuity

Objective

The objective of this policy is to ensure that gratuity entitlement and payment to employees are as per statutory requirements and employees enjoy long term tax benefits and monetary security

Scope

The policy applies to all permanent employees of TechAhead Software Ltd in India.

Policy Eligibility

- This policy will be governed as per the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972
- Gratuity shall be payable to an employee on the termination of his employment after he has rendered continuous service of five years. Gratuity amount is receivable by the employee only:

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- on his superannuation, or
 - on his retirement or resignation, or
 - on his death or disablement due to accident or disease.
- Completion of continuous service of five years shall not be necessary where the termination of the employment of any employee is due to death or disablement.
 - In the case of death of the employee, gratuity payable to the employee shall be paid to his nominee or, if no nomination has been made, to his heirs.
 - Any employee who is posted overseas will be eligible for the gratuity payout and the period of his overseas posting shall also be considered for the payout subject to completion of a total of 5 years of continuous service.

Nomination

Every employee who has completed one year of services with M/s TechAhead Software Pvt. Ltd. shall appoint nominee (s) as per the provisions of the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972, who will receive the gratuity amount of the employee in case of the death of such employee.

Calculation of Gratuity

Gratuity = (Last Drawn India Basic Monthly salary at the time of leaving / 26) * 15 *No. of years of service

- **Maximum amount of Gratuity payable:**
For entitlement of gratuity, there is no salary limit. All employees getting salary without any upper limit are entitled to be paid gratuity, subject to the condition that the maximum amount of gratuity will be INR 10 lakh.
- Gratuity amount paid to the employee is exempted from tax for up to INR 10 lakh and any amount paid above this limit is taxable
- The employee will be exempted from tax only when he/she gives a declaration that he /she has not received a gratuity amount above the maximum permissible amount in any previous employment(s).

Mode of payment:

Once an employee becomes eligible for the payment of gratuity under the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972 or any person is authorized in writing. TechAhead will release the eligible gratuity amount with the Full and Final Settlement of the employee.

The gratuity payable under the Act shall be paid in cash or, if so desired by the payee, in Demand Draft or bank cheque to the eligible employee, nominee, or legal heir.

Claim Process

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Once an employee becomes eligible for the payment of gratuity under the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972 or any person is authorized in writing, to act on his behalf, shall apply to M/s TechAhead Software Pvt. Ltd. within 30 (thirty days) from the date the gratuity becomes payable to him in the form prescribed in The Payment of Gratuity (Central) Rules, 1972.

Forfeiture of Gratuity

The amount of gratuity shall be forfeited if the services of an employee are terminated due to his riotous/ disorderly conduct, violent act, acts involving moral turpitude, or any action against the elements outlined in this Manual while in services of the M/s TechAhead Software Pvt. Ltd.

There shall be deductions from the outstanding amount of gratuity payable to an Employee for acts/ willful negligence or omissions causing any loss or damage to the property of the M/s TechAhead Software Pvt. Ltd., to the extent of loss or damage so suffered by the Company.

FAQ's

- **What is Gratuity?**

Gratuity is a lump sum amount that M/s TechAhead Software Pvt. Ltd. pays you when you retire or resign from the organization fulfilling the eligibility criteria. Gratuity is paid out at the time of superannuation (if you retire at the age of 55) when you retire (at any other age) or resignation, and in the event of employee death or being rendered disabled because of an accident or illness. This rule is relaxed in the last instance. In the event of employee death, the gratuity will be paid to his/her nominee.

- **How Gratuity amount is calculated?**

As per statutory requirements, it is the employer's liability to pay 15 days of Basic salary (15/26 of a monthly Basic) for every completed year of service on India payroll to each of his employees on their exit. Gratuity Calculation = [(Last Drawn India Basic Pay) x 15 days x No. of years of service] / 26

- **What are the exceptional cases under which gratuity is paid?**

In case of death of the employee, the nominees and if no nomination is made, then the legal heirs of the employee are eligible to be paid the gratuity amount by the employer.

- **On my separation date I have completed continuous service of 4 years and 240 days in the Company, will I be eligible for Gratuity**

Yes, you are entitled to be paid gratuity.

Disclaimer: Any modifications in the applicable laws shall be ipso facto applicable from the date of publication of such notifications in the official gazette of India.

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6) ADMINISTRATIVE POLICIES

6.1 Attendance

The attendance system followed by TECHAHEAD is a biometric system. All the employees are compulsorily to register their biometric on a day-day basis each time he/ she enters or leaves the office floor.

- i) The official timings begin from 10:00 A.M. on all working days. However, the grace period of 15 minutes will be available to each Employee without any salary deduction.
- ii) Grace period of 30 minutes will be available for the next day to only those employees who leave the office after 9:00 P.M.
- iii) Grace period of 1 hour will be available for the next day to only those employees who leave the office after 10:30 P.M.
- iv) Grace period of 1 hour 30 minutes is available only to the Employee who leaves office after 11:30 P.M.;
- v) A Grace period of ½ day (subject to arrival by 2:00 P.M. next) will be available to those Employees only for the next day who leave office after midnight.
- vi) If any Employee at a time must go out of the office premises for a period beyond half an hour, he/ she has to seek approval from his/ her delivery head.
- vii) If anyone engaged in client interaction/calls from home, they need to inform HR and their PM/RM.
- viii) If anyone is travelling to the client site should inform HR.
- ix) Those who are late or want to avail short leave the same day should inform the Delivery head and HR by mail or phone/message before 9:30 am, Information, after 9:30 am, will be treated as absent/LWP for the day.
- x) Every 2 days of late arrival (over and beyond the grace time) would equal to 1 half day of unpaid leave. The same would be automatically calculated and affect the number of days for payroll calculation of the employee.
- xi) Every 2 days of clocking less than 9 hours on the biometric/ time keeping software would equal 1 half day of unpaid leave.

6.2 Dress Code

All Employees are expected to maintain a clean, decent, and professional appearance. The attire of an Employee should be consistent with the type of work he/she is performing as well as being appropriate for

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the position such an Employee holds and the image Company seeks to project. Clothing must be tailored, neat, and clean. Good personal grooming and hygiene are also essential, and all employees should project a professional appearance during their working hours in the employment.

6.3 Personal Communication

Personal communication has no bearing whatsoever on our Company or the service conditions of our members. Examples of personal communication include emails, telephone calls, messaging/ texting correspondence with friends or family, responses to advertisements, and the purchase of personal goods.

TECHAHEAD values the importance of enabling its employees to properly balance work and their personal lives. TECHAHEAD recognizes that employees can use the corporate system to exchange personal e-mail from time to time, particularly in hardship conditions.

6.4 Phone Usage

Employees are not expected to entertain personal phone calls on their respective cell phones during work hours (except during pre-approved breaks). In cases that any Employee has to use the cell phone the same has to be done in the cafeteria, meeting rooms, and reception areas within the Company's premises. The team members are strictly barred against:

1. Sitting on their seats and making long-duration personal calls either using a hand-set or otherwise; or
2. Using public areas to make long-duration personal calls; or
3. All landline phones are only available for making and receiving business calls. A business call is defined as a call made for the purpose and with the intent of conducting business or seeking information for the business. If you are found using a landline phone for making personal calls, disciplinary action(s) may be initiated against you.
4. Mobile phones with cameras are not allowed to be used for taking photographs of the office premises, equipment, or personnel.

6.5 Visitors at Workplace

Visitors are only allowed at the Reception or the Visitor's room. Customers, Prospective Customers, and Business Guests if they are accompanied by senior Team Member(s) may be an exception to this policy.

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6.6 Use of Company Property and Intellectual Property

Company property, assets including tangible and intangible, designs, applications, source codes, object codes, facilities, and services must be used only for authorized purposes. Any intellectual property, such as trademarks, copyrights, and any work created by an employee partly or wholly either individually or together with any person, in the course of employment, or even during or outside the working hours at TECHAHEAD shall be the property of TECHAHEAD and the employee is deemed to have waived all rights in favor of TECHAHEAD. Work, for this policy, is wide enough to include written, creative or media work. All source material used in a presentation or written documents must be acknowledged.

- i) Employee shall not use, misuse, or copy any IPR of the Company such as trademark, copyright, design, or patented product/services during his employment with the Company or any time after termination of his services with the Company;
- ii) Employee shall not use, misuse, copy or disclose any of the Standard Operating Procedure, processes, practices, etc. designed by the Company.
- iii) Any company property (Laptop/ Desktop/ any other hardware or asset) in custody of the employee shall be kept in safe custody of the employee. Any theft/ loss or physical damage to such laptop/ desktop or other hardware/ asset would immediately be brought to the notice of the Company. In case of theft or loss of the laptop/ desktop/ hardware or asset the Company could recover the cost from the employee.

Employee shall deliver all the Intellectual Property rights in his possession which have either been acquired or developed by him during his employment with TECHAHEAD at the time of his disassociation with the Company along with its copies if any.

6.7 Safety and Accident Rules

Safety is a priority at Company. The company strives to provide a clean, hazard-free, and safe environment. All Employees are expected to take part in maintaining this environment. All Employees should observe all posted safety rules, adhere to all safety instructions provided by their supervisor, and use safety equipment when required. It is the responsibility of each Employee to learn the location of all safety and emergency equipment, as well as the safety and/or emergency phone numbers. Any problems with Company-provided safety equipment should be reported to one's immediate supervisor. If any employee feels that it is not safe to work for any reason, the problem must be brought to the notice of his/her respective supervisor immediately. All work-related accidents are covered by Worker's Compensation Act, 1923. A first- Aid Kit is

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available in the HR room. The medication from the first-aid kit is supplied for the convenience of employees and shall be applied by the employees as per their health conditions and medical requirements.

TECHAHEAD accepts no responsibility or liability arising from the use of the first-aid kit.

7) DISCIPLINARY POLICY

The following outlines TECHAHEAD's policy governing conduct and discipline. This policy is designed to promote peaceful, orderly, and safe conduct of employees while working in the Company or conducting the firm business, and to protect the Company's reputation in the community by prohibiting certain off-work employee conduct.

Discipline will be based on factors such as the severity of a violation, the repetitive nature of a violation, the circumstances surrounding a violation, and the frequency of the current or previous violations. Disciplinary actions may include an oral warning, a written warning, suspension with or without pay, and termination. These actions are not required to be taken altogether or in any particular order and TECHAHEAD may begin the disciplinary sequence with any action, including proceeding directly to termination. In all events, disciplinary decisions will be made in the best interests of the firm.

The prohibited conduct listed below represents the types of unacceptable behavior that will result in disciplinary action, up to and including discharge:

- Insubordination, including refusal to follow lawful instructions, rules, or directly from a supervisor (such as refusing to perform jobs other than those the employee typically performs).
- Theft of the Company's property including but not limited to the confidential as well as proprietary information or the property of other employees or possessing Company's property including confidential as well as proprietary information or the property of other Company employees without permission.
- Falsifying or altering Company's records, including employment records, timesheets, or job applications.
- Violation of the Company's policy prohibiting Unlawful Harassment or the Company's Equal Employment Opportunity policy.
- Poor job performance.
- Conduct off the job which causes workplace problems, or which, in the opinion of the Company, reflects poorly on the Company.

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- Wasting Company's materials or supplies.
- Using profanity of a sexual nature or using profanity or another language to taunt or provoke co-workers.
- Unauthorized use of the Company's equipment or materials.
- Violation of the Company's No Solicitation or No Distribution policies.

The list set forth above is not all-inclusive.

8) SEPARATION FROM EMPLOYMENT

8.1 Resignation

Employees under an employment contract are required to submit a notice of resignation in writing to their respective Delivery Head and HR before the date the employee intends resignation to take effect as per the notice period clause in the service contract, to assist Company in planning for your departure and replacement for the position of such Employee.

Employee agrees to serve the Company with mandatory notice of Ninety (90) days if the employee wants to resign/leave/terminate his Employment with the Company during the period of his Probation. Salary proportionate to the notice period not served would be adjusted against the FnF if the employee insists on early relieving. The employee is not eligible for any experience/relieving letter if the notice period is not fully served. The Company, if it deems fit, can relieve the employee at any point of time during the employee's Notice period. In case of early relieving initiated by the Company, the proportionate salary would be paid only till the date that the employee is relieved.

Employee agrees to serve the Company with mandatory notice of Ninety (90) days if the employee wants to resign/leave/terminate his Employment with the Company after his period of Probation and once his Employment is confirmed by the Company. Salary proportionate, to the notice period not served would be adjusted against the FnF if the employee insists on early relieving. The employee is not eligible for any experience/relieving letter if the notice period is not fully served. The Company, if it deems fit, can relieve the employee at any point of time during the employee's Notice period. In case of early relieving initiated by the Company, the proportionate salary would be paid only till the date that the employee is relieved.

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Do's & Don'ts During Notice Period:**Dos:**

1. Fulfil your responsibilities: Employees must continue to fulfil their duties as an employee until the last day of employment.
2. Handover: During the notice period, the employee should prepare a detailed handover report and pass on his/her knowledge to his/her successor.
3. Maintain professionalism: Employees must maintain a professional and courteous attitude during the notice period.

DON'Ts:

1. Speak ill of the company: Negative comments about the company, colleagues, or management during the notice period are strictly prohibited.
2. Breach confidentiality: Employees must continue to maintain confidentiality during the notice period and avoid sharing sensitive information about the company, clients, or colleagues.
3. Violate policies: Employees comply with all company policies during the notice period, including the use of company equipment and resources.

8.2 Termination

This termination clause is governed by the service contract according to which the Company reserves the right to terminate the services of the employee without any notice or salary thereof. However, there are additional grounds on which the Company may terminate the services of its Employees which are as follows:

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1. If the Employee fails to report to work without permission or remains absent beyond the period of leave originally granted or subsequently extended.
2. If the Employee fails to ratify the documents like educational testimonials and details of the employee's previous employment.
3. Where the employee suffers from any kind of mental or physical disability thereby preventing him/ her to perform the services effectively.
4. Or in case of misconduct, negligence of duty, disloyalty, dishonesty, indiscipline, disobedience, irregular attendance, unauthorized absence from the duty or inefficiency as compared to the other employees, or lower performance as compared to the other employees of his/ her category or any other indulgence of excess or any impropriety in complying with the terms of the HR Manual of the Company.

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5. Or on death/ demise of the Employee

Notwithstanding the above, the service of an employee with the Company may be terminated at any time, after confirmation, by giving written notice of such term as prescribed in the Service Contract of the respective Employee or payment of commensurate salary in lieu thereof. Upon termination of employment for any reason whatsoever, the employee will immediately deliver to his/ her Reporting Manager at the Company all papers, software programs, notes, data, worksheets, reference materials, memoranda, documentation, software, tools, apparatus, programs, equipment, and any other materials or property physical or intellectual belonging to the Company or that were prepared or made, in whole or in part, by him/her at any time during his/her employment with the Company along with its copies, if any and that which is in his/her possession at the time of such termination.

9) ONBOARDING POLICY

The onboarding policy at TechAhead is designed to ensure a smooth and structured transition for new employees by familiarising them with the company's culture, policies, and operations. This approach helps enhance engagement, clarity, and productivity from the very first day.

Pre-Joining Process:

Before the joining date, the HR team collects essential documents such as previous employment letters, salary slips, ID proofs (Aadhar, PAN, Passport), address proofs, and educational certificates. As part of the background verification (BGV) process, candidates are required to share employment references. The HR team verifies these references and authenticates the submitted documents to ensure the accuracy of personal, educational, and professional details.

Joining Day Process:

On the day of joining, an employee ID is generated and the Keka profile is set up by HR. A structured induction session is conducted covering core values, HR policies, the Discipline and Corrective Action Policies, the BGV Policy, medical insurance, company history and achievements, and ISMS training (Information Security Management System). This is followed by floor induction, where new employees are introduced to senior management and taken on a tour of the office premises.

Access provisioning is then completed, which includes setting up access to Keka, Zoho, Outlook, and Teams, along with laptop allocation based on role or project. Biometric registration is carried out at all three office entry points for attendance tracking, while logical access is provided according to project needs.

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The employee is assigned a designated workstation, and the IT team ensures the necessary systems and software are in place. A buddy is assigned to each new hire to ease their adaptation into the company culture. HR also assists in opening a salary bank account with the designated banking partner.

To encourage cultural integration, a welcome lunch with the team is organised. Additionally, hands-on Keka training is conducted to guide employees on attendance, leaves, payroll, and internal HR communications. Finally, the joining documentation is completed, which includes signing the Employee Service Contract, Appointment Letter, Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA), and a Self-Declaration of HR Manual Form.

10) EXIT PROCESS POLICY

The Exit Process Policy ensures a smooth and structured transition when an employee leaves TechAhead, whether through resignation, termination, or retirement. It is designed to manage exits professionally and in compliance with internal procedures, while maintaining business continuity and protecting company assets. When an employee chooses to resign, they must submit a formal resignation email or letter to both their reporting manager and the HR department. Upon receipt, HR will schedule an exit interview to gather feedback that may help improve workplace practices. All feedback will remain confidential and will be used solely for internal enhancement purposes.

The employee is required to complete a thorough knowledge transfer (KT) process before their last working day. This includes documenting all ongoing tasks, sharing critical project details, and handing over responsibilities as directed by the reporting manager to ensure a smooth transition.

As part of the exit formalities, employees must complete an Exit Clearance Form, which includes approvals from various departments. The IT team will ensure the return of all company-issued equipment such as laptops, ID cards, and devices. Finance will verify the clearance of reimbursements and salary-related dues. Additionally, all system and platform access—including Keka, Zoho, Outlook, Teams, and project-specific tools—will be deactivated on the last working day. Physical access through the biometric system will also be revoked accordingly. The Admin team will collect access cards and other assets. HR will confirm the completion of the exit interview and ensure all documentation is in order.

The final settlement process will be handled by HR, which includes processing pending salary, reimbursements, and issuing key documents such as the Relieving Letter, Experience Letter, and Full & Final Settlement Statement—typically within 30 to 45 days from the exit date.

Lastly, employees are reminded to strictly adhere to the Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) even after exit and to avoid sharing any confidential or proprietary information acquired during their tenure at TechAhead.

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It is important to note that Company reserves the right to review, revise, delete, add, amend, interpret, modify, or withdraw any portion of the Service Rules contained in the HR Manual at any time at its discretion.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

PLEASE READ THE EMPLOYEE SERVICE CONDITIONS IN THE HR MANUAL AND FILL OUT AND RETURN THIS PORTION TO THE HUMAN RESOURCE DEPARTMENT ON THE SAME DAY OF YOUR RECEIVING THIS HR MANUAL

Employee Name: _____

Post Held: _____

I, _____, acknowledge that I have received a copy of the HR Manual wherein the Company's Service Rules containing _____ pages cover all clauses. I have familiarized myself with the contents of the said rules and acknowledge, understand, accept, and agree that I am responsible for knowing and adhering to the policies outlined in the HR Manual during my employment with the Company. I understand that these Service Rules are not intended to cover every situation which may arise during my employment, but as a general guide to the goal, policies, practices, benefits, and expectations of the Company and the terms and conditions in the Service Agreement are more designation specific.

The Company reserves rights to review, revise, delete, add, amend, interpret, modify, or withdraw any portion of the Service Rules contained in the HR Manual, at any time.

Signature of the Employee:

Date:

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